

Zoebar Business Group

Search and AI-Visibility Strategy: Coffee-First Revision

Prepared by: Lambda **Date:** 18 August 2026 **Supersedes:** Strategy dated 9 August 2026 **Companion documents:** Revised Proposal (Aug 2026), CLAUDE.md, Claude Code Build Playbook **Status:** Working strategy. Sections marked OPEN require a Zoebar decision.

0. What changed and why this revision exists

The original strategy assumed three trading divisions. The client has since confirmed:

- **Hospitality is removed entirely.** Not deferred, removed.
- **Produce is out of scope for this build.** Coffee is the only product currently selling. Produce returns only when it is genuinely trading, and it will be re-planned then.
- **eCommerce is undecided.** Nothing is built for it until the client decides.
- **Coffee is the flagship** with maximum depth: Amaro origin, the Zoebar-owned washing station, traceability, the From Origin series.
- **The homepage opens with the story, not keywords.** The client is explicit and correct: this is a trust-led brand.
- **Farmer credit is a stated purpose of the site**, not a decoration. The site exists partly so the farmers of Amaro get visible credit for the coffee.
- **Phase Two retainer:** 60,000 ETB over three months (was 90,000). Phase One unchanged at 60,000. Total 120,000 ETB.
- **Build timeline:** ten working days from kickoff to launch.
- **Verified live:** the current robots.txt permits all crawlers. The earlier "crawlers blocked" finding is withdrawn. The accurate finding is worse: crawlers are allowed in and there is nothing worth quoting.

Everything below is written for a coffee-only site.

1. The commercial problem in one paragraph

Zoebar sells high-value green coffee to professional buyers: specialty roasters, medium and family-owned coffee companies, green coffee importers. These buyers research, shortlist, request specifications and samples, then negotiate. The research now happens in two places Zoebar is absent from: Google’s results and AI answer engines. By the time a buyer could plausibly find zoebarbusinessgroup.com, the shortlist already exists. This strategy has one aim: be present during research, not after it.

2. Foundation decisions

2.1 Domain (DECIDED, with one open check)

Build on **zoebarbusinessgroup.com** as a coffee-first site. The homepage leads with coffee as the flagship; the group identity remains for legal, banking and contractual reasons, but the site presents commercially as a coffee specialist.

Register **zoebarcoffee.com** and 301 it to the site (or to /coffee) so ads, cards and trade-show banners carry a clean product address. Register zoebarproduce.com defensively and park it. Do not register anything for eCommerce until it is defined.

OPEN check: if paid search becomes a serious channel, Google Ads display-URL rules may favour building on zoebarcoffee.com as primary instead. Verify before committing paid budget. Organic, social and offline use of a redirect is fine.

Why not one domain per product: authority accrues to a domain. Splitting divides backlinks, entity records and trust-building across properties, and none reach the threshold where they rank. Two sites claiming to be Zoebar’s coffee business is exactly the inconsistency that makes an AI engine cite someone else.

2.2 Crawler policy (OPEN, recommendation stands)

The live robots.txt allows all crawlers but names no AI agents and has **no Sitemap directive**. The new site's policy:

Crawler	Recommendation
Googlebot, Bingbot	Allow
GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User	Allow (required for ChatGPT citation)
ClaudeBot, Claude-User	Allow
PerplexityBot	Allow
Google-Extended	Allow
CCBot	Allow
Unidentified aggressive scrapers	Block at the edge

The trade-off, honestly: allowing AI crawlers means specifications and price indications can be summarised without a visit. In exchange, Zoebar

becomes citable at the moment a shortlist forms. For a B2B exporter, being named in the answer is worth far more than a pageview that would not have converted. Recommendation: allow, documented in the repository with a dated rationale so a future developer does not silently reverse it.

2.3 Typeface licence (OPEN)

Canela Deck requires a commercial web licence. If not approved, a licensed alternative display serif is chosen before build, not after.

2.4 The trust rule

From the client's brief, applied to every page: *"We would rather say 'we are verifying that information' than provide an unsupported claim."* Unknown specifications are marked as being verified. They are never filled with plausible numbers.

3. Site architecture

zoebarbusinessgroup.com	Coffee-first. Story-led homepage.
└─ /coffee	The offer: grades, specs, availability, terms
└─ /amaro	Origin: Koore Zone, altitude, varieties, the washing station. Primary citation target.
└─ /process	Cherry to container, real timings, both washed and natural tracks
└─ /quality	Grading, cupping, inspection
└─ /traceability	How far back a lot can be traced
└─ /farmers	The people of Amaro, named, with permission
└─ └─ /farmers/[slug]	Individual producer profiles
└─ /lots/[slug]	Lot-level pages. QR code destinations.
└─ /journal	From Origin series, articles, harvest updates
└─ └─ /journal/[slug]	
└─ /guides	Evergreen buyer resources
└─ └─ /guides/[slug]	
└─ /about	Entity, structure, licences
└─ └─ /about/founder	Meet the Founder
└─ /contact	
└─ /request-quote	Primary conversion
└─ /lp/[campaign]	Lead magnets, noindex
└─ /thank-you	noindex

Removed from the original architecture: /produce, /produce/cold-chain, /hospitality, and the three-division framing throughout. Added: /amaro as its own page, /farmers, /lots, /about/founder.

3.1 The two-density design system

One design language, two densities, so the story pages and the specification pages read as one company:

- **Story surfaces** (/ , /amaro, /journal, /farmers): full-bleed sections, generous space, emerald-over-ink mesh with a warm sand glow, photography carrying the emotional weight, one idea per screen.
- **Specification surfaces** (/coffee, /process, /quality, /lots): dense, scannable, real HTML tables, minimal motion, facts stacked tight.

Same tokens, type, card geometry and motion vocabulary throughout. Only spacing, density and motion volume change. The shift between them is a deliberate gear change a buyer feels as "story, then proof."

3.2 Farmer credit as structure

A stated purpose of the site. Built as:

- A **farmer profile content type**: name, plot, altitude, years with Zoebar, photograph, their own words where possible, and a **permission field without which a profile cannot publish**.
- **Lot pages link to the people who grew the lot**. This is what turns traceability from a claim into a fact.
- Farmers presented as **skilled producers**. Never charity, poverty or rescue framing. This rule is absolute and comes from the client's own brief.
- **Person** and **Place** schema on profiles. Named people at verifiable places are quotable by AI engines, and almost no exporter publishes them. This is simultaneously the ethical position and the citation advantage.

4. Workstream A: Search

4.1 Query architecture

One page, one commercial intent. Volumes validated at kickoff before copy is written.

Page	Primary intent	Supporting phrases
/	Brand; Ethiopian green coffee exporter Dubai	,
/coffee	Ethiopian green coffee supplier / exporter	green coffee wholesale UAE, bulk Ethiopian arabica
/amaro	Amaro coffee / Sidama coffee origin	Koore Zone coffee, Amaro Gayo region, Sidama category
/process	coffee export process, lead times	washed process Ethiopia, FOB Djibouti coffee
/quality	coffee grading, cupping, inspection	SGS coffee inspection, Ethiopian grade standards
/traceability	traceable coffee sourcing	washing station traceability, lot traceability
/farmers	who grows [origin] coffee	smallholder producers Amaro
/guides/*	informational, top of funnel	see 4.2
/request-quote	transactional	request green coffee quote

The Amaro/Sidama page is the sharpest asset. Buyers search "Sidama"; the truth is Koore Zone, commonly traded within the broader Sidama category. Writing that accurately, prominently, on a dedicated page serves the search term and the truth simultaneously. Nobody else in the market has written it properly. Accuracy becomes the ranking advantage.

4.2 Pillar guides, first quarter

1. **The Ethiopian Coffee Grading System, Explained.** Grades, defect counts, cupping thresholds, uses.
2. **Amaro Harvest and Shipping Calendar.** By grade, with realistic transit to Gulf, European and Asian ports. Updated annually. Original data only Zoebar can publish.
3. **The Importer’s Documentation Checklist.** Phytosanitary, certificates of origin, ICO documentation, inspection.
4. **Incoterms for Green Coffee Buyers.** FOB, CIF, CFR as they actually apply out of Djibouti, with worked examples.

Each 1,200–2,000 words, **Article** schema, answer-first, cross-linked to /coffee and /amaro. Guides 5 and 6 (evaluating a supplier; washed vs natural in depth) move to quarter two.

4.3 Technical floor

- Server-rendered or statically generated HTML on every indexable route
- Core Web Vitals green on mobile: LCP < 2.5s, INP < 200ms, CLS < 0.1
- robots.txt per 2.2, **with a Sitemap directive**, each rule commented
- XML sitemap auto-generated, submitted to Google and Bing
- Self-referencing canonicals; 301 map from every current URL
- hreflang scaffolding for en and ar from day one
- Specification data in real HTML tables, never images or div grids
- All motion transform/opacity only; content in the DOM before any script runs; reduced-motion renders final state instantly

4.4 Internal linking

- Every guide links to /coffee or /amaro in its first three paragraphs
- Every page links to /request-quote; story pages once, spec pages twice
- Lot pages link to their farmers and their origin
- No page more than three clicks from home

4.5 Off-site authority, ordered by return

1. Google Business Profile for the Dubai office, completed and verified
2. One canonical entity record used verbatim on every directory, LinkedIn and profile
3. Trade directory and Gulf platform listings, consistency over quantity
4. Guides 1 and 2 offered to coffee trade publications once live
5. Harvest data and price indications as recurring digital PR material

5. Workstream B: AI visibility

5.1 What is being optimised

An answer engine cites content that is retrievable (crawler allowed, content in HTML), parseable (self-contained factual passages), attributable (unambiguous entity), and corroborated (same facts everywhere). Every item below serves one of those four.

5.2 Answer-first pattern, every content page

1. An **H2** phrased as the buyer’s actual question.
2. A 40–60 word self-contained answer directly beneath: numbers, place names, altitudes, dates. No back-references. It must survive being quoted alone.
3. Then the depth for the human reader.

"Zoebar supplies washed and natural Ethiopian Arabica from Amaro (Koore Zone) at 1,700–1,800 masl, harvested September to December and processed at Zoebar’s own washing station" is citable. "We pride ourselves on quality" is not.

5.3 Structured data map

Page	Schema
Home	Organization, WebSite
/coffee	Product with additionalProperty per spec, Offer where terms are public
/amaro	Place with geo and elevation, Article, FAQPage
/process, /quality	Article or HowTo, FAQPage
/traceability	Article, FAQPage
/farmers/[slug]	Person, Place
/lots/[slug]	Product with additionalProperty
/journal/[slug]	Article with datePublished, dateModified, named author
/about	Organization (full), BreadcrumbList
/contact	Organization with ContactPoint

One canonical entity module in the codebase; every Organization block derives from it. Validated before merge, re-validated monthly.

5.4 Machine-readable index

- llms.txt at root listing the pages that matter, one line each
- Semantic HTML: article, section, figure, figcaption, table, dl, time
- QR codes on sacks and sample bags resolve to /lots/[slug]

5.5 Citable original data

Engines cite facts nobody else has. Zoebar’s exclusives: the Amaro harvest calendar, monthly availability and price indications, grade comparison tables with cupping bands, real port-to-port transit times, named producer profiles. This data is the reason to be cited over a competitor, and the reason a buyer subscribes.

5.6 Prompt-set monitoring

A fixed set of 25 buyer questions tested monthly across ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews. The set never changes, or the trend is meaningless. Sample:

- Who exports Ethiopian green coffee from Dubai?
- Where can I source Sidama-category washed coffee at container volume?
- Which Ethiopian coffee suppliers own their washing station?
- Who supplies traceable Amaro coffee?
- What documentation do I need to import Ethiopian green coffee?

Recorded per prompt, per engine: mentioned or not, linked or not, position, competitors named. Reported monthly as one visibility score plus a competitor table.

6. Lead generation

6.1 Funnel

LinkedIn / Instagram post with one specific offer → /lp page (one promise, one form, no navigation, noindex) → capture (name, company, country, volume band, email) → instant delivery → /thank-you with one next-step ask → CRM tagged by volume → sales follow-up within 24 hours.

WhatsApp is a first-class channel on every page with page-aware prefilled messages; Gulf and East African buyers negotiate there by default.

6.2 Launch assets, coffee only

Asset	Purpose
Amaro Green Coffee Buyer’s Pack	Broad top-of-funnel capture
Monthly Availability and Price Indication	Recurring: one download becomes twelve touchpoints a year
Sample Request (3 × 350g)	Highest-intent action on the site
Importer’s Documentation Checklist	Shareable, link-worthy, low commitment

The Produce Export Spec Sheet from the original plan is removed. Four assets, not five. The monthly price sheet remains the strategically important one: it builds a list with a standing reason to re-engage.

7. The three-month retainer

Month 1, stabilise and baseline. Full indexation in Search Console; schema validation; baseline rank positions and AI visibility score; Google Business Profile completed; first four journal entries from the LinkedIn archive; baseline report.

Month 2, expand and correct. Technical audit pass; entity consistency sweep across directories; guides 1 and 2 published; first conversion review on the lead-magnet pages; four journal entries; first month-on-month report.

Month 3, compound and plan. Guides 3 and 4 published; outreach on guides 1 and 2; second AI visibility measurement giving the first trend line; reallocation toward what is working; four journal entries; final report plus a written recommendation for the continuing engagement.

Retainer fee: 20,000 ETB per month, three months, from launch.

8. Measurement

Metric	Source	Cadence
Pages indexed vs submitted	Search Console	Monthly
Impressions and clicks by query	Search Console	Monthly
Tracked keyword positions	Rank tracker	Weekly, reported monthly
AI visibility score	Fixed prompt set	Monthly
Competitors in AI answers	Fixed prompt set	Monthly
Core Web Vitals field data	Search Console / Vercel	Monthly
Lead-magnet conversion rate	Analytics events	Monthly
Qualified enquiries by source	CRM	Monthly

Ninety-day targets: 100% of pages indexed clean; 25+ tracked keywords trending up; four engines tested monthly with Zoebar’s appearance rising; Core Web Vitals green on mobile; a fully attributed lead flow.

Not promised: rankings or citations, which depend on competitors and platform changes nobody controls. What is guaranteed is the work: delivered, measured, reported with real numbers, reallocated when the numbers say so.

9. Risks

Risk	Handling
Specifications or photography arrive late	Week-one deadline stated; the ten-day timeline moves rather than quality dropping
Farmer permissions incomplete	Permission field blocks publishing; profiles launch progressively
eCommerce decision reopens scope	Nothing is built until defined; treated as new scope when it arrives
Canela licence unresolved	Alternative selected before build
AI platforms change citation behaviour	Monthly fixed-prompt measurement makes the change visible
Competitor starts the same programme	Entity establishment compounds; first mover keeps the advantage

10. Beyond the first quarter

1. **Programmatic lot and grade pages** at scale from the templates already built
2. **Arabic pages** on the hreflang scaffolding; Gulf buyers researching in Arabic face almost no exporter competition
3. **Interactive harvest and shipping calendar** as a citable original asset
4. **Traceability QR programme** printed on sacks at volume, resolving to lot pages
5. **From Origin video** production (Remotion is a candidate toolchain for branded clips)
6. **Produce**, re-planned as its own effort when it is genuinely trading, likely as its own site since it is a different buyer
7. **eCommerce**, scoped fresh when the client defines it

11. Open items

#	Item	Blocks	Needed by
1	eCommerce: in or out, and what it is	Architecture edges	Before launch
2	Crawler policy sign-off	robots.txt	Build day 8
3	Canela web licence or alternative	Design system	Kickoff
4	Coffee specifications (grades, screens, cupping bands, MOQ, packing, yields, lead times, Incoterms, port)	/coffee, /process, /lots	Day 1–2
5	Sample policy	Sample Request asset	Day 3
6	Traceability depth	/traceability, lot pages	Day 3
7	Founder story, photo, permission	/about/founder, homepage	Day 3
8	Farm and washing station photography	Every story surface	Day 1–2, hard blocker
9	Farmer names, photos, documented permissions	/farmers	Progressive, post-launch OK
10	Legal entity details, TRN, addresses	Schema, footer	Day 4
11	CRM / email platform choice	Form delivery	Day 4
12	LinkedIn archive	/journal seeding	Week 1

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